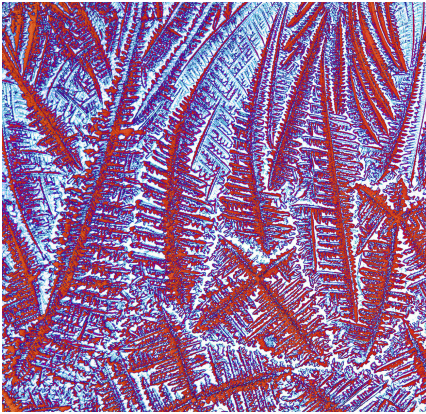




THIS IS **DAY 10 OF YOUR MENSTRUAL CYCLE**

270 days to go

WHAT'S HAPPENING INSIDE

As ovulation approaches, more cervical mucus is produced. Here it has crystallized to form a “fern leaf” pattern. Around the time of ovulation the mucus becomes clear, slippery, and stretchy, which makes it easier for sperm to swim through.

“ You may not care whether you have a boy or a girl, but according to some theories you can influence gender. ”

Conceiving is all about having sex at the right time this week, but if you're hoping to have a child of a specific gender, the timing could be even more important. Some experts claim there is a link between when you have sex and the baby's gender (see [Conceiving boys and girls](#)).

Recent research suggests that women who have a high calorie intake (especially if they eat bananas) are marginally more likely to bear a boy. Those who skip breakfast or have a low calorie intake are more likely to have a girl. One reason for this is thought to be that the extra calories consumed affect vaginal secretions help to give the Y sperm that makes baby boys a vital boost.